

23
V

Laboratory
sample of
pure vanadium
crystals



Vanadium does not change shape, even when hot, so it is used to build the latest nuclear fusion reactors.

24
Cr

Chromium

Pure chromium is mixed with steel to stop it from rusting – producing shiny stainless steel. Compounds of chromium come in bright colours, such as purple, yellow, and red.



Laboratory sample
of pure chromium

ATOMIC MASS 51.996

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1798 (Nicholas Louis Vauquelin)

25
Mn

Manganese

When pure, manganese is a dull grey metal that is hard and brittle. It is mixed with silicon into steel to harden it. This tough steel can be used to make tank armour.



Chunk of
rhodnite, an ore
of manganese

ATOMIC MASS 54.938

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1774 (Johan Gottlieb Gahn)